

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] Thank you very much again. In this interview, we are curious about your perspectives on relationships, specifically romantic relationships, and will be asking you questions about it. We believe your experience and perspective will greatly contribute to the project. Thank you again for agreeing to participate. First, I'll ask a few demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:28] [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:00:29] [20-25]. How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:34] Um, [<1 year]

Speaker 1 [00:00:38] Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 No.

Speaker 1 Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:00:47] Well, I usually live at my family home, but right now I'm not living there. At the family home, there are my sibling, mother, and father.

Speaker 1 [00:00:56] Hm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:00:57] Currently, as I mentioned, I'm in an open relationship. I'm living with a different partner and their mother.

Speaker 1 [00:01:06] Okay, what is your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:01:11] Currently, I receive it from [source].

Speaker 1 [00:01:14] What is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:17] I am a [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:01:20] How would you like me to refer to your partner? Spouse, lover, partner?

Speaker 2 [00:01:25] You can say partner.

Speaker 1 [00:01:27] Okay, thank you. Can you tell me the story of how you met your partner and how your relationship began?

Speaker 2 [00:01:35] Um, actually, my partner was a friend of my another partner, and they were going to work on a project. We met on the way. My other partner had already mentioned them to me. So, we first met through their friendship. Later that day, we had a lot of conversations and became closer. Initially, we were more like friends, but over time, our friendship deepened, and we became more intimate.

Speaker 1 [00:02:28] I see. How would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:37] Um, I think it's a bit above average.

Speaker 1 [00:02:51] Can I ask why you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:02:54] Well, as I said, in terms of communication, I think we are better at it. When there's an issue, we can communicate more easily. I think we're more clear with each other.

Speaker 1 [00:03:09] Can you elaborate on what you mean by clarity?

Speaker 2 [00:03:13] I mean expressing when something is bothering us or when we have a problem with each other.

Speaker 1 [00:03:20] How many relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:03:33] [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:03:35] Uh-huh. Okay. How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous ones?

Speaker 2 [00:03:44] Similar. I think it's almost at the same level.

Speaker 1 [00:03:49] Why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:03:51] Well, generally speaking, I think we approach each other in similar ways. But maybe in terms of closeness, we spend less time together now because we attend different schools. In my previous relationships, we spent more time together. But in terms of communication and showing love (sevgi), I think this relationship is a bit more intense. Communication-wise, it's similar.

Speaker 1 [00:04:51] Can you give some concrete examples of how you show love (sevgi)?

Speaker 2 [00:04:56] Both verbally, like giving compliments and warmth, and physically, like hugging. I think it's more intense compared to other relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:05:13] You mentioned spending less time with your current partner. Do you think this affects your relationship quality?

Speaker 2 [00:05:23] Sometimes I think it does. We both want to spend more time together, but school periods make it difficult.

Speaker 1 [00:05:37] What makes a relationship high-quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:05:46] I think it's about how well you know each other and how much you are part of each other's lives.

Speaker 1 [00:05:59] Can you elaborate on being a part of each other's lives?

Speaker 2 [00:06:05] Being aware of each other's processes.

Speaker 1 [00:06:12] Why do you think being aware of each other's experiences contributes to a high-quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:22] It creates closeness, not just emotionally but also in other aspects, and helps us support each other.

Speaker 1 [00:06:33] So, can we say that high-quality relationships are those where you support each other and are part of each other's lives?

Speaker 2 Yes.

Speaker 1 Can you give more information on how one can tell if they are in a relationship where they are part of their partner's life?

Speaker 2 [00:07:00] For example, how often you communicate during the day or how much you support each other when something happens. If there's a sudden development I didn't know about, it means we haven't communicated well.

Speaker 1 [00:07:34] When do you feel most supported and part of each other's lives, and when do you feel the least?

Speaker 2 [00:07:48] In my current relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:07:50] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:07:51] Before I went abroad last term, we were very close and strong. But around the time I returned, we had less communication. Now, I feel it's getting stronger again. But last term before going abroad was the best.

Speaker 1 [00:08:22] What do you think caused the distance and what caused the improvement?

Speaker 2 [00:08:31] Being physically apart, my going abroad, making new friends, and their focus on summer school. We both noticed the distance and felt uncomfortable. We talked about it and started making more effort to stay connected.

Speaker 1 [00:09:07] Can you give concrete examples of the effort you made?

Speaker 2 [00:09:11] Before, we could meet spontaneously. Now, we put more effort into planning our meetings. We also try to communicate more often through messages.

Speaker 1 [00:09:41] What are the most important things for you in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:54] Love (sevgi), strong communication, and closeness, both physical and emotional.

Speaker 1 [00:10:21] Can you elaborate on why strong communication and closeness are important?

Speaker 2 [00:10:32] Without them, I think communication weakens.

Speaker 1 [00:10:40] What does love (aşk) mean to you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:47] It's an emotional bond that goes beyond friendship.

Speaker 1 [00:11:03] What differentiates it from friendship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:12] A stronger desire to spend time together and a deeper emotional connection.

Speaker 1 [00:11:28] How important is love (aşk) in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:33] I think it's necessary but doesn't have to be the main focus.

Speaker 1 [00:11:43] What should be the main focus then?

Speaker 2 [00:11:50] Strong communication and the value you give each other, beyond just love (aşk).

Speaker 1 [00:11:59] How do you know your partner loves (seviyor) you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:12] I need meaningful words and actions. Especially at the beginning, I need verbal expressions to understand they see me as more than a friend. Later, actions like thoughtful gestures also show me.

Speaker 1 [00:12:53] Can you give concrete examples of verbal expressions in [Language]?

Speaker 2 [00:12:59] Saying something that indicates they see me as more than a friend, like expressing they enjoy spending time with me in a different way.

Speaker 1 [00:13:30] What about actions? Can you give examples?

Speaker 2 [00:13:48] Bringing me something thoughtful, like a cookie they know I like, shows they were thinking of me.

Speaker 1 [00:14:21] What challenges do you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:14:26] Finding common time and social expectations. They are more social and comfortable in larger social circles, while I am more introverted. Different schools and social environments also create challenges.

Speaker 1 [00:15:20] Do you and your partner argue?

Speaker 2 [00:15:24] No.

Speaker 1 [00:15:26] Do you have any disagreements?

Speaker 2 [00:15:36] We have discussions on various topics but nothing that escalates into an argument.

Speaker 1 [00:15:53] How do you resolve these discussions and challenges?

Speaker 2 [00:16:00] Being physically close helps us resolve things more easily.

Speaker 1 [00:16:10] What makes physical closeness so effective?

Speaker 2 [00:16:19] It makes us feel more comfortable and connected.

Speaker 1 [00:16:22] Does it enhance verbal communication?

Speaker 2 [00:16:33] Yes, it makes communication easier even if we talk less.

Speaker 1 [00:16:43] Besides physical closeness, what are other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:55] Clear communication and staying in touch, even if it's just brief messages.

Speaker 1 [00:17:13] Why do you think this is important?

Speaker 2 [00:17:18] It prevents emotional distance and keeps us connected.

Speaker 1 [00:17:33] Do you think this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:17:38] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:17:39] Why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:17:42] Because it makes me feel close and happy in a way different from my other relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:18:01] What makes this relationship different from your previous ones?

Speaker 2 [00:18:06] The emotional and physical comfort it provides, largely due to my partner's character.

Speaker 1 [00:18:23] Can you give examples of your partner's emotional openness?

Speaker 2 [00:18:38] Unlike my previous partners who were more logical, my current partner is emotionally open and values me for who I am, not just my actions.

Speaker 1 [00:19:30] Do you prefer emotional or logical communication for a high-quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:53] Generally, I prefer logical communication, but in arguments, I prefer an emotional approach.

Speaker 1 [00:20:05] Why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:20:07] Because sometimes logic can't resolve everything, and emotional understanding is needed.

Speaker 1 [00:20:19] Why do you value logical communication otherwise?

Speaker 2 [00:20:28] It makes it easier to discuss and solve issues rationally.

Speaker 1 [00:20:36] Do you think this relationship has changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:20:43] In some ways, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:20:48] In what ways?

Speaker 2 [00:20:49] It has changed my perspective on people and relationships, making me realize the importance of communication and quality time.

Speaker 1 [00:21:02] Can you elaborate on that?

Speaker 2 [00:21:06] It has made me more aware of how people treat me and what I expect from relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:21:48] What have you realized about your expectations from relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:21:54] I've realized that I can be happy with less frequent but more meaningful interactions.

Speaker 1 [00:22:41] You mentioned that your perspective on people has changed. Can you explain how?

Speaker 2 [00:22:58] I've become more aware of what behaviors I find acceptable or unacceptable in others.

Speaker 1 [00:23:23] How did you use to think about this?

Speaker 2 [00:23:27] I was less clear about my boundaries and what I wanted.

Speaker 1 [00:23:36] Do you think your partner has changed during your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:44] Yes, they have become more confident and assertive.

Speaker 1 [00:24:16] Can you explain how their behavior changed?

Speaker 2 [00:24:24] They are now more comfortable expressing themselves and standing up for themselves.

Speaker 1 [00:24:43] Do you feel safe in this relationship? Why?

Speaker 2 [00:24:53] Yes, because I know my partner values me and we can solve any issues that arise.

Speaker 1 [00:25:13] How do you know your partner values you?

Speaker 2 [00:25:23] Through both their words and actions, like how they introduce me to others.

Speaker 1 [00:25:38] I'm going to share a screen with you now. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:25:46] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:25:47] On a scale of 1 to 9, how true is the statement: "My partner usually listens to me"?

Speaker 2 [00:25:59] Seven.

Speaker 1 [00:26:01] And the statement: "My partner is usually sensitive to my needs"?

Speaker 2 [00:26:10] Eight.

Speaker 1 [00:26:12] You rated "My partner usually listens to me" as seven. Why?

Speaker 2 [00:26:30] Because they generally listen, but sometimes, especially when stressed, they might not fully listen.

Speaker 1 [00:26:37] Can you give concrete examples?

Speaker 2 [00:26:48] For instance, when I talk about politics, they might lose interest and change the subject.

Speaker 1 [00:27:06] Does this affect your relationship quality?

Speaker 2 [00:27:13] Not significantly, because I understand their interest might differ.

Speaker 1 [00:27:36] Why did you choose seven instead of six or eight?

Speaker 2 [00:27:43] Because I think they listen well most of the time, but not always perfectly.

Speaker 1 [00:28:06] You rated "My partner is usually sensitive to my needs" as eight. Why?

Speaker 2 [00:28:16] Because they are generally sensitive, but sometimes their own needs might take precedence.

Speaker 1 [00:28:45] Can you give concrete examples?

Speaker 2 [00:28:56] For example, if I want to go somewhere and they don't, they might not be as accommodating.

Speaker 1 [00:29:19] Does this affect your relationship quality?

Speaker 2 [00:29:28] It can, but if they explain their reasons, it doesn't bother me as much.

Speaker 1 [00:30:05] Why did you choose eight instead of seven or nine?

Speaker 2 [00:30:49] Because there are exceptions, and I think eight reflects their general sensitivity accurately.

Speaker 1 [00:31:02] How often do you engage in sexual activities these days?

Speaker 2 [00:31:19] Rarely.

Speaker 1 [00:31:32] How satisfied are you with your sexual life?

Speaker 2 [00:31:37] I wish it were more frequent.

Speaker 1 [00:31:41] Do you think sex is important in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:31:48] If both people enjoy it, yes. But I can be happy in a relationship without sex too.

Speaker 1 [00:32:03] On a scale of 1 to 9, how satisfied are you with your relationship overall?

Speaker 2 [00:32:52] Seven or eight.

Speaker 1 [00:33:01] Why did you choose seven?

Speaker 2 [00:33:07] Because while things are good, I wish we could spend more time together.

Speaker 1 [00:33:25] Why not six or eight?

Speaker 2 [00:33:31] Because I think seven reflects our relationship's quality better. It's above average but not perfect.

Speaker 1 [00:34:13] Does your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:34:21] Mostly, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:34:24] What doesn't meet your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:34:31] Sometimes, I wish we could prioritize our time together more and have more quality time.

Speaker 1 [00:34:52] How do you define quality time?

Speaker 2 [00:35:15] Talking, doing enjoyable activities together, or just being present for each other.

Speaker 1 [00:35:32] Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:35:34] No, I think we covered everything.

Speaker 1 [00:35:34] Okay. We are almost done. I want to summarize what we discussed. You are [20-25] years old and have been with your partner for [<1 year] You live with another partner and their mother. You get financial support from your [source] and are a [occupation]. You met your partner through a mutual friend. You feel your relationship is above average in quality due to strong communication. You have had[1-5] past relationships and feel your current one is similar in quality but with less physical closeness. Important aspects of a high-quality relationship for you are love (sevgi), strong communication, and being a part of each other's lives. You felt closest before going abroad and more distant afterward. You think aşk is necessary but not the main focus. You need meaningful words and actions to feel loved (seviliyor). Challenges include finding common time and differing social expectations. You don't argue but have discussions. Physical closeness helps resolve issues. Maintaining communication is key to keeping the relationship strong. You feel the relationship is good for you and it has changed your perspective on people and relationships. Your partner has become more confident. You feel safe in the relationship because you know your partner values you. You rated your partner's listening and sensitivity as seven and eight respectively. You rarely have sex and wish it were more frequent. You rate your relationship satisfaction as seven or eight and feel it mostly meets your expectations. You wish for more quality time together.

Are these correct, and do you have anything to add or correct?

Speaker 2 [00:40:34] Yes, that's correct. I just want to clarify that we met through mutual friends working on a project, not directly through a project group.

Speaker 1 [00:42:12] Thank you very much for participating in this study. Your insights are invaluable. Before we finish, we would like to ask if you could recommend two close people who might also be interested in participating in this study. We aim to reach more participants through referrals.

Speaker 2 [00:42:45] Sure. Should I provide their contact information now?

Speaker 1 [00:42:48] No, you can message me later. I'll send you a message with more details.

Speaker 1 [00:43:37] Thank you again for your valuable contribution. We will also send you a short follow-up survey that will take no more than 10 minutes to complete. Please use the participant code [Code] when filling it out to keep your responses anonymous. Thank you again.

Speaker 2 [00:43:37] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:43:41] Goodbye.